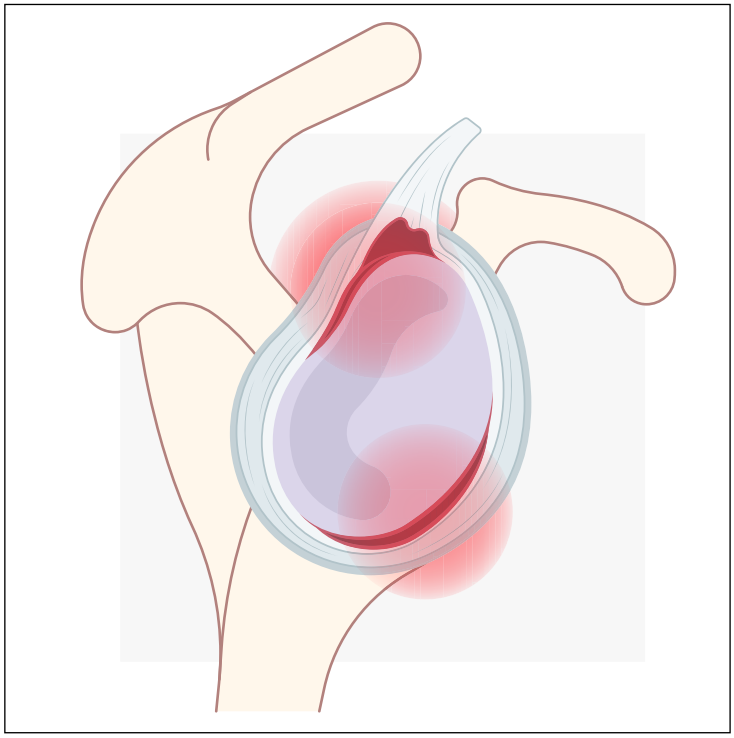
Glenohumeral Internal Rotation Deficit

Background

- Glenohumeral Internal Rotation Deficit (GIRD) is caused by repetitive "internal rotation motions." This repetitive motion leads to "posterior shoulder capsule" tightness and causes decreased range of motion. The posterior shoulder capsule is a fluid-filled sac at the back of the shoulder that lubricates and protects the shoulder joint.
- "Internal rotation motion" is how you move your arms to reach into your back pocket or tuck your shirt into your back waistband.
- GIRD is commonly seen in younger athletes who specialize in throwing sports. It can also occur in adults who perform repetitive overhead motions or with high levels of shoulder stress from occupational or recreational activities, and those with poor shoulder mechanics or shoulder weakness or previous shoulder injuries.
- Primary symptoms are decreased internal rotation, pain in shoulder with throwing and overhead activity, and decreased shoulder function and weakness.
- Diagnosis is made by comparing the internal rotation of both shoulders. A difference of more than 20-degrees of internal rotation indicates GIRD.
- Primary treatment is activity modification and rest along with rehabilitation to improve ROM, strength, and shoulder stabilization. A biomechanical assessment can be helpful to reduce the chance of recurrence.

Latest Research

- Research suggests that untreated GIRD can lead to further shoulder and elbow injuries if not addressed and corrected.
- One study demonstrated that a combination of posterior capsule stretching and scapular stabilizing exercises improved internal rotation in throwing athletes within 7–9 weeks.



Rehab Instructions

Stretching Exercises

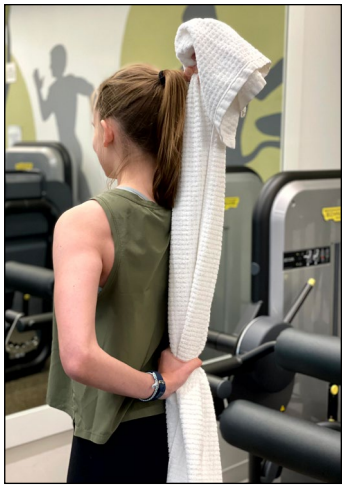
Cross-Body Stretch:

- Place your affected arm across your body, grab it with your opposite arm, and pull it towards your chest.
- Keep your body straight. You can avoid twisting your body by standing with your back against a wall.
- Hold the stretch for 15–30 seconds.

Complete 3 reps 2 x a day.



Towel Stretch:



- Stand up straight with a towel over your shoulder and grab the towel end behind your back with your affected arm.
- Use your other arm to gently pull on the front end of the towel to stretch your back arm.
- Hold the stretch for 15–30 seconds.

Complete 3 reps 2 x a day.

Sleeper Stretch:



- Start by lying on your side with your affected arm on the bottom. Bend that elbow to a 90-degree angle.
- Next, use your opposite hand to gently draw your affected forearm towards the floor until you feel a mild stretch.
- Hold the stretch for 15–30 seconds.

Complete 3 reps 2 x a day.

Strengthening Exercises

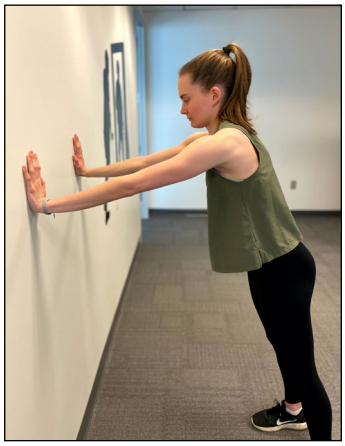
No Money:



- Hold a resistance band with your palms facing up.
- Keep your elbows locked at your sides and bent at a 90-degree angle.
- Rotate your arms out while squeezing your shoulder blades together and pulling them down, as if you're "tucking them into your back pockets."

Complete 3 sets of 15 reps 1 x a day.

Pushup Plus (shown on wall):



- Lean forward against a wall, engage your core, and do a push-up.
- At the top of the pushup, continue to push your upper back away from the wall. This will cause your shoulder blades to round slightly. This is a very subtle movement, and you'll only move a few inches or less.
- To increase the difficulty and progress, do the push-ups against a countertop, then against a couch, and, eventually, on the floor.

Complete 3 sets of 10 reps 1 x a day.

Practical Tips for Success

- Perform all exercises in a slow, controlled manner.
- If you're a throwing athlete, continue to incorporate core and lower body strengthening exercises into your routine.
- Do not push stretches past the point of pain. These stretches should involve gentle, easy pressure.
- Remember that improving your range of motion takes time. Be patient and consistent with your stretches and exercises.

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